John T Hoggard IB Assessment Policy

IB Mission Statement

The International Baccalaureate aims to develop inquiring, knowledgeable and caring young people who help to create a better and more peaceful world through intercultural understanding and respect. To this end the organization works with schools, governments and international organizations to develop challenging programmes of international education and rigorous assessment. These programmes encourage students across the world to become active, compassionate and lifelong learners who understand that other people, with their differences, can also be right.

John T Hoggard Mission Statement

The mission of John T. Hoggard High School is to ensure all students will become productive, responsible, independent, internationally minded lifelong learners who adapt and succeed in a democratic, diverse, global environment.

Assessment Philosophy

Assessment is integral to providing quality teaching and learning. It provides both the student and the teacher with valuable feedback to determine and improve learning. Using assessment instruments allows all stakeholders to gauge where students are, recognize their strengths and weaknesses, and provide instructional support to help them grow.

For assessments to be effective, they should:

Reflect the holistic and international mindedness of the International Baccalaureate (IB) programme by ensuring assessments are balanced and free of cultural bias.

- Provide students with clear learning targets that enable students to monitor their progress throughout the course.
- Provide opportunities for stakeholders (teachers, learners, and parents) to reflect and be provided with feedback based on performance.
- Be balanced in the content and standards being assessed and the depths of questions.
- Place students at the center of learning.
- In addition, teachers should use a variety of assessments (both formative and summative) that demonstrate a mastery of skills and content knowledge that focus on both abstract and concrete concepts and ideas.

DP Credit & Diploma

In order for students to earn an IB Diploma, they must:

- Complete a course from each of the 6 groups of study.
- Complete at least 3 High Level courses.
- Complete 2 or 3 Standard Level courses.
- Earn at least 12 points combined for HL courses.
- Earn 5-9 points combined for SL courses (depending on the number taken.)
- Score no lower than 2 on 2 courses.
- Score no lower than 3 or below in 3 courses.
- Complete Internal Assessments for each course.
- Sit for all External Assessment Papers in the IB testing window (May.)
- Score a minimum total of 24 points, with each course score ranging from 1-7.
- Complete EE - Extended Essay.
- Complete TOK – Theory of Knowledge.
- Complete CAS.

IB and North Carolina Requirements

IB assessment principles and practices align directly with the NC required practices and systems for grading and reporting. Students are responsible for completing NC assessment requirements in conjunction with the IB requirements.

Assessment Styles in IB Classrooms

To receive course credit in an IB class, students are assessed on their abilities to analyze and present information, evaluate and construct arguments, and creatively solve problems. Students are expected to display basic academic skills of retaining information and applying concepts; additionally, a more holistic and intercultural outlook is expected.

Formative Assessments
The purpose of formative assessments is to provide timely feedback on students' growth and to support, motivate, and encourage students to take risks as they develop new skills and challenge themselves in the learning process. Formative assessment used by IB teachers may include but are not limited to, self-reflections, visual presentations, oral presentations, short constructed responses, performances, quizzes, questioning, discussion, self-evaluations, Socratic seminars, and exit tickets.

Summative Assessments
To determine mastery of skills and demonstrate growth, teachers utilize a variety of assessment strategies that allow students to apply their academic skills and concepts in new ways. Formative assessment used by IB teachers may include but are not limited to, exams, essays, presentations, projects, portfolios, performance-based tasks, and past released IB exam papers. Grades on such assignments are based on IB teachers' professional judgment using rubrics aligned to IB standards and expectations.

Benchmark Practice Exams/Internal Moderation, Final Exams
In order to moderate and ensure that coursework is a reflection of IB standards, IB DP Year 2 and IB students in 1 year-long classes students take practice IB (i.e. Benchmark) exams during the midterm of their courses. This also provides teachers with data to support IB predicted grades. Course final exams given at the close of the course count as 20% of the overall Infinite Campus average for the entire course. These Finals will either be IB aligned practice paper assessments or IA/IOs. Final course exams are administered at the end of the year. This testing window does not coincide with the IB Examination calendar.

Internal Assessments (IAs)
During their course work, students will complete Internal Assessments, which are part of their overall assessment score for each course. Rubrics, mark bands, and grade conversions will be clearly communicated to students by their subject teacher(s). Teacher autonomy is allowed per course to implement internal deadlines and assessment scores for portions of each IA. In order to aid students in time management, major deadlines will be approved by the IB Coordinator and shared on an IB Assessment Calendar. Each IB teacher will assess these assignments and submit them to IB for moderation. Students (both DP and Course) must complete an IA/IO for each course in order to earn a qualifying IB score.

The completion of all IB internal assessments is required of all students registered in IB courses. Students who fail to complete any of these assignments and/or who are found guilty of academic misconduct will be withdrawn from the relevant subject registration(s) with the IB and thus will lose IB candidacy as well as the opportunity to earn college credit in that subject area. Furthermore, a failure to complete these assessments will have a significant impact on the Infinite Campus course grade for tthe relevant subject(s).

Internal Moderation will take place in order to ensure that the internally monitored coursework is of the standard of IB. In subjects with more than one teacher, a selection of sampled papers could be scored by both the current classroom teacher and a subject specialist. IB teachers will use data from previous years' IB IA Assessments to aid in the internal standardizing of assessment.

Extensions to IB due dates are available from the IB only in cases of significant extenuating circumstances, such as long-term hospitalization, civil unrest, war, or natural disaster.

Standardized IB Exam Papers
IB Exam Papers, or external assessments, combine with internal and for most courses to determine student credit in IB courses. Exams are administered following strict IB guidelines and on dates set by IB. If there is a conflict between exam dates, the other exam will need to be rescheduled.

Homework and Extended Opportunities
Homework guidelines differ according to the content area. Teacher autonomy is allowed per subject area. Homework will be utilized by teachers to analyze students' progress towards the development and acquisition of key skills as well as to provide meaningful feedback to students before the summative assessment. Homework will allow teachers to support student mastery of content and to inform instruction. Homework can provide opportunities for students to collaborate with their peers and teachers, as well as engage in self-assessment and peer assessment.

IB teachers will plan horizontally to help monitor homework expectations in order to provide students with a balance with time management and extra-curriculars. The goal is to help develop well-rounded individuals. In order to aid students in

time management, major homework assignments and course expectations, including deadlines, will be approved by the IB Coordinator and shared on an IB Calendar. At the beginning and end of each year, the coordinator meets with all IB faculty by group to discuss the previous year's results and to consider revisions to teaching practices/curricula in response to those scores. Teachers may also consider registering for workshops for practice and/or consultation with colleagues in the larger IB community.

Grading within IB Courses

Students' grades and performance in all IB courses will be determined using a number of formative and summative assessments clearly aligned to the IB curriculum. IB teachers must use their professional judgment to assess the coursework and score assessments using IB Grade Boundaries from prior testing session. When given an assessment aligned with an IB paper, students' marks awarded based on IB rubrics are converted to scores entered in PowerSchool. Grade conversions are based grade mark bands and the conversion chart below:

Infinite Campus%	IB score
98%-100%	7
90%-97%	6
78%-89%	5
60%-77%	4
50%-59%	3
40%-49%	2
0-39%	1

Grade Reporting

Grades are recorded and reported to students and parents through Infinite Campus. Parents have access to students' grades at all times with the Parent Portal application. Progress Reports and Report Cards are sent home according to the New Hanover County Schools traditional school calendar.

Missed Class/Make up Work Policy

IB students are expected to follow Hoggard High School's attendance policy as outlined in the Student Handbook. Because IB courses often include assessments, presentations, labs, and other activities that are difficult to recreate, students and families must follow the additional IB notification procedures below.

If You Know You Will Be Absent

For a **scheduled appointment, college visit, or other planned absence**:

1. Notify the Hoggard attendance office in writing.
2. Email your IB teacher(s) at least 24 hours before the absence.
3. Provide documentation within 24 hours of the appointment/visit if documentation was not already submitted.
    - Documentation may be a screenshot, email, appointment confirmation, or other appropriate verification.
4. For a college visit, the appropriate approved college-visit form must be completed.

Important: Simply telling your teacher that you will be absent does not replace the required attendance-office documentation.

🤒 If You Are Absent Unexpectedly

For an unscheduled absence, the **student or parent must provide a written excuse within 24 hours of missing class.**

The excuse must be:

- An email from a parent/guardian OR
- An email from the student with a parent/guardian copied on the email from the parent's Infinite Campus listed email address.

The email should be sent to:

- Your IB teacher(s)

⚠ **Why is this important?**

If the required written excuse is not provided within the required timeframe, the absence may be treated as unexcused for IB class purposes.

Students with an unexcused absence will not be given make-up opportunities for missed work. This includes tests and other IB assessments.

What Counts as an Excused Absence?

Under Hoggard/New Hanover County Schools attendance rules, excused absences may include:

- Personal illness or injury that prevents the student from attending school- **Parent or Doctor's Note REQUIRED**
    - This applies to the student, not illness or injury of a parent or other family member.
- Required isolation or quarantine under applicable health regulations
- Death in the immediate family, including parents, grandparents, and siblings
- Medical or dental appointments
- Court or administrative proceedings when the student is a party or subpoenaed witness
- Certain religious observances
- Pregnancy-related medical needs or parenting responsibilities, when medically necessary
- Certain military-family circumstances involving an active-duty parent/legal guardian
- Other reasons specifically approved by the Board
- College visits with the required approved form

📑 What Happens When I Miss Class?

If your absence is EXCUSED:

You have 24 hours to communicate with your IB teacher and arrange your make-up work.

Your teacher will provide information about:

- Missed assignments
- Class activities
- Assessments
- Labs or other activities that need to be completed
- Appropriate deadlines for completing missed work

If your absence is UNEXCUSED:

You are not eligible to make up missed work for that class period.

This includes tests and other assessments.

Roles and Responsibilities
Communication between all involved is needed to promote a holistic mindset. Lines of communication should be open and used to aid in the success of our students on all assessments. Each stakeholder in the IB programme is responsible for keeping communication open and fair for all.

Learners
Students are responsible for self-advocating and determining when additional assistance or instruction on a topic is needed prior to any assessment given. Students should engage in self-assessment and peer assessment to help promote a reflective and collaborative learning environment. Collaboration is essential to students gaining a full understanding and holistic view of the IB content. Students should use resources to help create a time management plan to help them manage the coursework for the IB program along with their other responsibilities. The attributes of the IB learner profile are the expected aspirations of all IB students.

Parents
Parents should support students and the school by promoting the IB learner profile, holistic thinking, and higher-level thinking needed in IB courses. Parents should understand that assessments, both formative and summative, serve as an opportunity to increase knowledge and learning. Assessments serve as a chance for the student to grow and reflect.

Teachers
Teachers should facilitate learning through providing clear guidelines and rubrics for students to use during the course. These should be consistent and applicable to the courses in which they are used. Teachers should continually assess students using both formative and summative assessments. Teachers should use these assessments to aid students in gaining the required understanding of the course as well as connecting their content to the other areas of IB. Teachers should collaborate with other teachers, students, parents, and administrators to ensure that their rigor and coursework is consistent with IB philosophy. Teachers should demonstrate to students' time management strategies through planning the course and by keeping students on track to complete their assignments in a timely manner.

IB Coordinator
It is the IB coordinator's responsibility to assist teachers in the implementation of and adherence to the policy by providing access to IB documents and the IB Programme Resource Centre.

Administrators
Administrators' responsibility is to ensure compliance with the policy and to provide the staff development needed to implement the policy. Further, they should reinforce the procedures for assessing IB students in a fair manner. They should do this through open communication and support of the students, teachers, and parents.

Links to other Policies

Language and Special Educational Needs Policies: Students' language requirements will be accounted for in developing, implementing, and evaluating assessments. Students' special educational requirements as detailed in Individualized Educational Plans or 504 Plans will be accommodating in developing, implementing, and evaluating assessments.

Academic Honesty Policy: Students will adhere to all the requirements detailed in the John T. Hoggard Academic Honesty Policy. This policy applies to all assessments given in the classroom and to all IB diploma assessments. Students sign a declaration of authenticity confirming that all the work submitted for IB assessment is their own work. Effective October 3, 2025

Resources

This policy was adapted from Needham B. Broughton High School IB Diploma Programme Assessment Policy, Raleigh, NC; General regulations: Diploma Programme (2016); Diploma Programme: From principles into practice (2015).

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